

WordPress → Static HTML

User guide: how the converter works, what it can and cannot do, and the rules to follow

In one sentence: you give the tool a WordPress backup file (`.wppress`), and it gives you back a ZIP of plain HTML pages that look like the original site and can be uploaded to any web hosting, cPanel included, with no WordPress, PHP or database needed.

1. What you need

Item	Details
The backup	A <code>.wppress</code> file made with the All-in-One WP Migration plugin. Other backup types are not supported.
Computer	Windows PC with the tool installed (run <code>setup.ps1</code> once). 16 GB RAM is comfortable. The tool measures the machine when each job starts and uses as much of it as is safe, so a faster PC simply finishes sooner.
Free disk space	About 3 × the backup size on the drive where jobs are kept (<code>C:\wpssc-jobs</code>). A 3 GB backup needs about 9–10 GB free.
Internet	Not needed for the conversion itself. The tool never contacts your live website.

2. How to start a conversion

Option A: the web screen (easiest)

- Run `run.ps1`. A terminal window opens; keep it open.
- Open `http://127.0.0.1:8000` in your browser.
- Under **File on this computer**, pick your backup. Nothing is uploaded or copied; it is read where it is.
- Check the options. **One folder per page** and **Link to folders** are on by default (see section 4), and **Concurrent pages** is set to **Auto**. Then click **Start conversion**.
- The screen shows the current step, the time left for that step and for the whole job, and a live log.

Option B: the command line

```
cd B:\Automation\wordpress-to-html
.\venv\Scripts\python.exe convert.py "C:\bkp\site.wpress" --jobs-dir C:\wpssc-jobs -o C:\wpssc-jobs\exports --screenshots
```

How many pages render at once is measured from your PC; add `-c 5` to force a number. `--screenshots` turns on the visual comparison. `--flat` gives `about.html`-style pages instead of folders, and `--file-links` writes links as `contact-us/index.html` (see below).

3. The workflow, step by step

Every job goes through the same 9 steps. Times are from a real 3.2 GB site with 686 pages.

1 Extract the backup

Unpacks the `.wordpress` file: the WordPress files, themes, plugins, images and the database export.

About 5 minutes

2 Restore WordPress

Builds a private, temporary copy of the website on your computer: its own small database and web server, invisible to anyone else. All links that point to the live domain are switched to this local copy, so nothing is ever fetched from the real website. The theme and plugins are switched on, and cache or security plugins that would get in the way are paused, in the copy only.

About 20 minutes (mostly loading the database)

3 Start WordPress

Starts the local copy and waits for the first page. The very first page view after a restore can take several minutes, because WordPress and Elementor rebuild their caches. The tool waits up to 15 minutes for that.

1–5 minutes

4 Find all pages

Asks WordPress for every published page, post, category and custom content type, reads the sitemaps, and later also follows links found inside pages, so pages that nothing else lists are caught too.

Under 1 minute

5 Render pages

Opens every page in a real browser (Chrome), lets everything load and animate, scrolls down so lazy images appear, then saves the finished page exactly as a visitor would see it. Analytics and tracking are blocked, so your statistics are not affected. Images, CSS and scripts are read straight from disk for speed.

The longest step: about 25 minutes for 686 pages

6 Create the HTML files

Rewrites every saved page for static hosting. Every menu, footer, sidebar and button link is changed to point at the exported page (for example `contact-us/` ; see "Link style" below). A page that cannot be written is recorded as failed; the job continues with the rest.

About 7 minutes

7 Collect assets

Gathers every image, stylesheet, script and font the pages use, from the backup's own files. It also includes the "on-demand" scripts (for example a carousel's code) that only load while a page runs.

Under 1 minute

8

Check and repair

Tests the finished site. Any file that is missing from the export but exists in the backup is copied in automatically and checked again. It also opens one or two pages of every page design in a browser to look for errors, and compares screenshots of the original and the export.

About 10 minutes

9

Package the ZIP

Puts the whole site into one ZIP file and writes a report explaining what was found.

About 3 minutes

Typical total: about 1–1½ hours for a 3 GB backup with around 700 pages. Smaller sites finish much faster; sites with thousands of pages take longer.

4. What you get

Output	Where / what
The ZIP (to upload)	<code>C:\wpssc-jobs\exports\<site-name>-static.zip</code> . An existing ZIP is never overwritten; a new one gets <code>-2</code> , <code>-3</code> added to its name.
The unzipped site	<code>C:\wpssc-jobs\<job-id>\output\</code> . Open <code>index.html</code> to browse it from your computer.
The report	<code>C:\wpssc-jobs\<job-id>\report\conversion-report.html</code> . Read the Quality check and Static HTML limitations sections.
Screenshot comparisons	<code>C:\wpssc-jobs\<job-id>\screenshots\</code> : original, export and a "diff" image with the differences in pink.

Page layout

Setting	Result
One folder per page (default)	<code>contact-us/index.html</code> . On a web server the address stays <code>/contact-us/</code> , exactly like WordPress, so Google rankings and old links keep working.
One file per page (<code>--flat</code>)	<code>contact-us.html</code> . The web addresses change to <code>/contact-us.html</code> .

Link style

Setting	Result
Link to folders (default)	Links are written as <code>contact-us/</code> , the same addresses WordPress used. This is what you want for cPanel or any web server. Opened straight from a disk, such a link shows the folder's file list instead of the page, because there is no server to open <code>index.html</code> for you.
Link to files (untick the box, or <code>--file-links</code>)	Links are written as <code>contact-us/index.html</code> . Works on a web server <i>and</i> when opening the pages from a disk or USB stick. The addresses are longer.

Putting it online (cPanel)

- Open cPanel, then **File Manager**, then `public_html` .
- Upload the ZIP and click **Extract**, so that `index.html` ends up directly inside `public_html` .
- Open your domain to check. The site also works inside a sub-folder.

5. What the tool can do

Feature	In the export
Page design, fonts, colours, layout, desktop and mobile	Exact copy

Elementor and other page builders (Gutenberg, Divi, WPBakery...)	Exact copy, as rendered by the real site
Menus, dropdowns, mobile menu, footer and sidebar links	Work; links point directly to the pages
Buttons that go to another page	Work
Buttons that open a popup, scroll, or show/hide something	Work (same scripts)
Elementor popups (on click, on load, delayed, on exit)	Work when the popup is part of the page (Elementor's normal behaviour)
Sliders, carousels, tabs, accordions, animations, sticky headers	Work
Background images, lazy-loaded images, responsive images	Included
YouTube/Vimeo videos, Google Maps, WhatsApp and chat widgets	Work (they load from their own services)
Linked PDFs and documents on your site	Included
SEO: page titles, meta tags, same web addresses (folder layout), sitemap.xml, robots.txt	Kept or generated
Speed of the finished site	Usually faster than WordPress: no PHP or database

6. What the tool cannot do (limitations)

A static site has no server program behind it. Anything that must *send* information to the website, or ask it for new information, will **look** right but will not **work**.

Feature	In the export	Why / what to do
Contact and quote forms (Elementor Forms, Contact Form 7, WPForms)	Look right, cannot send	Sending needs WordPress. Connect the form to a form service (Formspree, Web3Forms, Getform) or a small PHP mail script. cPanel supports PHP, so a mail script works there.
reCAPTCHA	Shows, cannot verify	Checking needs a server; handled by the form service or mail script.
Site search	Does not work	Use a static search tool or Google site search.
"Load more", AJAX filters, infinite scroll	First results only	Extra results are fetched from WordPress at click time.
Popups whose content is fetched when opened	May be empty	Rare with Elementor. The report lists pages that use AJAX.
Posting comments, user login, member areas	Do not work	Need PHP and the database. Existing comments are shown.
WooCommerce cart, checkout, payments, stock	Do not work	Product pages can be shown as a catalogue only.
Anything that changes on its own (live prices, scheduled posts, counters)	Frozen	The export is a snapshot of the day it was made. Re-convert to update.
Pages behind a login, drafts, private pages	Not exported	Only published, public pages are converted.
Pages nothing links to and WordPress does not list	May be missed	Very rare. Up to 5,000 pages per job by default.
Fonts and scripts from other websites (e.g. Google Fonts)	Still load online	Kept pointing at their original service by default.
Images missing from the backup itself	Stay missing	They are broken on the live site too. The report lists them; fix them in WordPress.

Every report lists these for your specific site under "Static HTML limitations", for example "Elementor Forms on 1 page". Read it before publishing so you know which forms or features need attention.

7. Understanding the Quality check

Result	Meaning
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Repaired automatically	Files that were missing from the export but found in the backup, and copied in. Nothing for you to do.
Problems	Something the conversion got wrong. The job is shown as " <i>Completed with N problem(s)</i> ". The ZIP is still made; check the listed pages before publishing.
Source issues	Things that are broken on the original website too: links to pages that do not exist, images missing from the backup. Fix them in WordPress, then re-convert.
Visual similarity	How closely the export's screenshots match the original, compared per page design. Around 90% or more is normal. Carousels stopping on a different slide lower the score without being a real problem; look at the pink "diff" image to judge.

8. Rules to follow

1. **Use only** `.wpress` **backups** made with All-in-One WP Migration.
2. **Keep 3 × the backup size free** on the jobs drive before starting.
3. **Let the tool decide how hard to work.** "Auto" measures cores and memory when each job starts. Set a number by hand only if you want to keep the PC free for other work.
4. **One conversion at a time** on a normal PC. Each job runs its own database, web server and browser; a machine with 8 or more cores and 32 GB of memory may run two.
5. **If a job stops or fails, resume it; do not start again.** Resume re-uses everything already done: the restored site, the database and every page already rendered. In the web screen click **Resume**; on the command line use `--resume <job-id>`.
6. **Never resume the same job from the web screen and the command line at the same time.**
7. **Do not delete a job folder** (`C:\wpssc-jobs\<job-id>`) until you are happy with the result. It is what makes resume possible.
8. **The tool never deletes your data by itself.** Your backup file is only read. A previous output is renamed to `output-previous-...`, and an existing ZIP is never overwritten.
9. **Keep the terminal window open** while a job runs. Closing it stops the job (it can be resumed). Clicking inside the window is safe.
10. **Read the report before publishing**, especially "Quality check" and "Static HTML limitations".
11. **Fix content problems in WordPress, not in the export.** Then make a new backup and convert again, so the next export is correct too.
12. **The export is a snapshot.** After changing the WordPress site, make a new backup and re-convert.
13. **Keep the web screen private.** It only runs on your own computer (`127.0.0.1`); do not expose it to the network.

9. Quick troubleshooting

What you see	What to do
Job failed while starting WordPress or rendering	Resume it. Nothing already done is repeated.
"Not enough free space"	Free up space on the jobs drive (3 × the backup size), then start or resume.
Job list in the web screen looks empty	Press Ctrl+F5 to reload the page.
"Completed with problems"	Open the report, then the Quality check section. The ZIP is usable; review the listed pages.
A form does not send on the live static site	Expected. Connect it to a form service or a PHP mail script (section 6).

Clicking a link opens a folder list instead of a page	You are opening the site from a disk, where folder links cannot work. On a web server it is correct. To browse locally, untick Link to folders and convert again.
Background images missing on the local preview	Normal when the live site is offline; the final export includes them. Check <code>output\index.html</code> .